A Apex CRM

Apex CRM — User guide

How to sign in, find your way around, and run your clients, sales, projects and invoices.

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1. What Apex CRM is

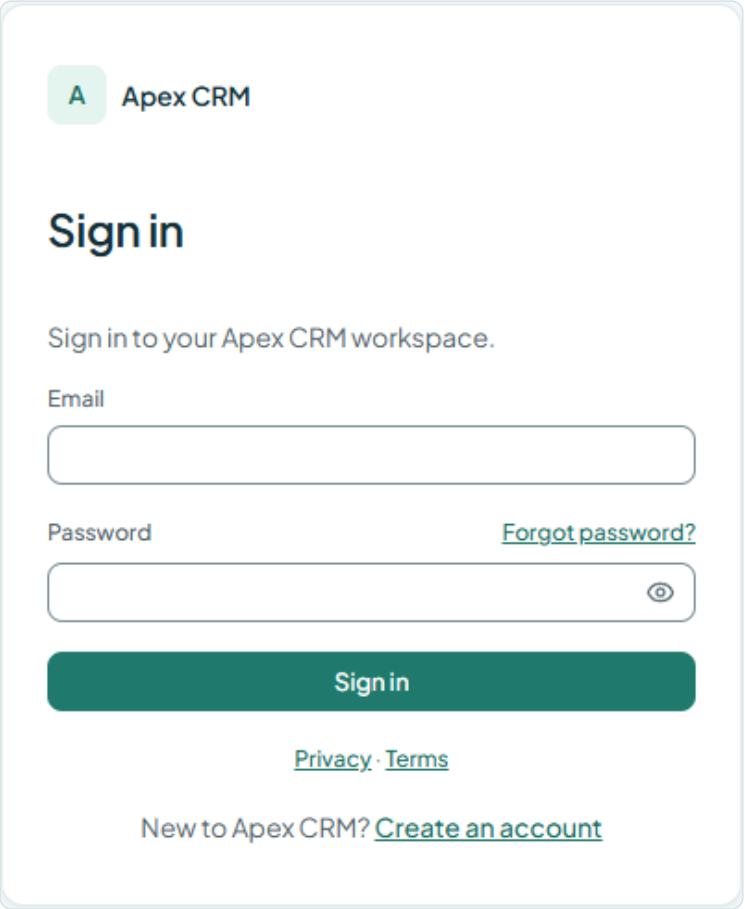
Apex CRM is a website you open in any browser — on a computer, a tablet or a phone. There is nothing to install. It keeps everything about your business in one place: your clients, the deals you are chasing (leads), the projects you deliver, your tasks, quotations, invoices and the payments you receive.

It works in English, French and Arabic. Arabic screens read from right to left. You can switch language at any time from the top bar.

- Clients — the companies and people you work with.
- Leads — possible deals, from first contact until you win or lose them.
- Projects and Tasks — the work you deliver and who does what by when.
- Quotations and Invoices — documents you send; payments you record against them.
- Follow-ups — calls, emails and meetings you must not forget.
- Reports — how much you invoiced and collected, who pays late, why deals are lost.

2. Your account

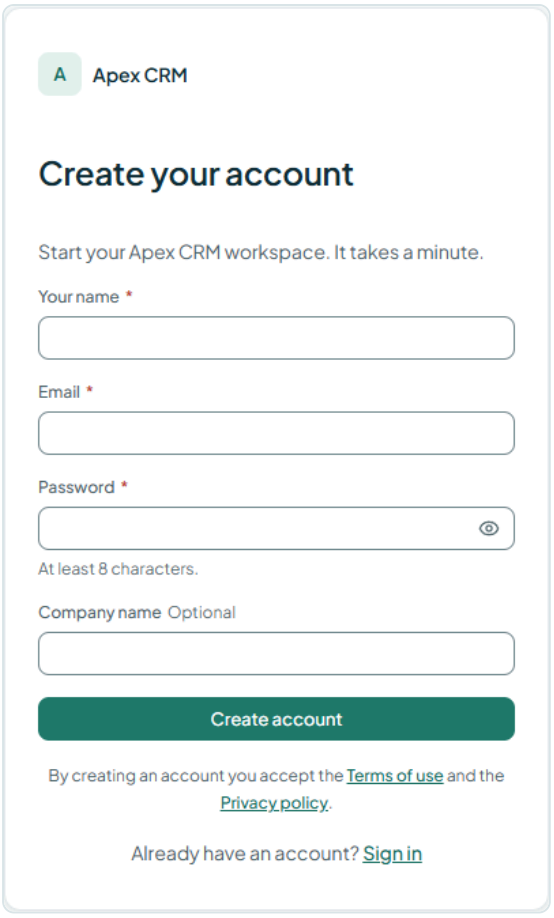
Open the address of your Apex CRM (for example http://localhost:3000 on your own computer). If you are not signed in, you see the sign-in page.



The sign-in page.

Create an account

1. On the sign-in page, click “Create an account”.
2. Type your name, your email and a password of at least 8 characters. The company name is optional.
3. Click “Create account”. You are signed in straight away, in a new, empty workspace that belongs to you.
4. We send you an email “Confirm your email”. Open it and click the button. Until you do, a yellow bar at the top of the app reminds you (it has a “Resend link” button).



Creating an account.

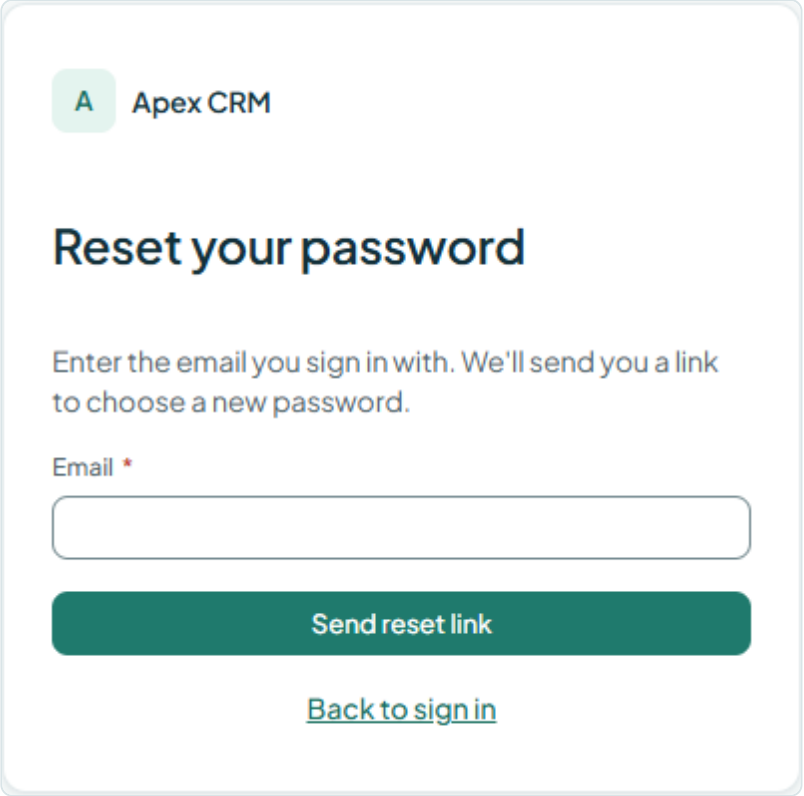
> **Tip**
>
> Confirming your email matters: it is how you get back in if you forget your password.

Sign in with Google

When Google sign-in is switched on (see chapter 13), the sign-in and sign-up pages show “Continue with Google”. Click it, choose your Google account, and you are in. If you already have an Apex CRM account with the same email, Google signs you into that same account.

Forgot your password?

1. On the sign-in page, click “Forgot password?”.
2. Type the email you sign in with and click “Send reset link”.
3. Open the email “Reset your Apex CRM password” and click “Choose a new password”. The link works once and only for 60 minutes.
4. Type your new password twice and click “Save password and sign in”. You are signed in, and every other computer or phone that was signed in to your account is signed out.



Asking for a reset link.

Tip

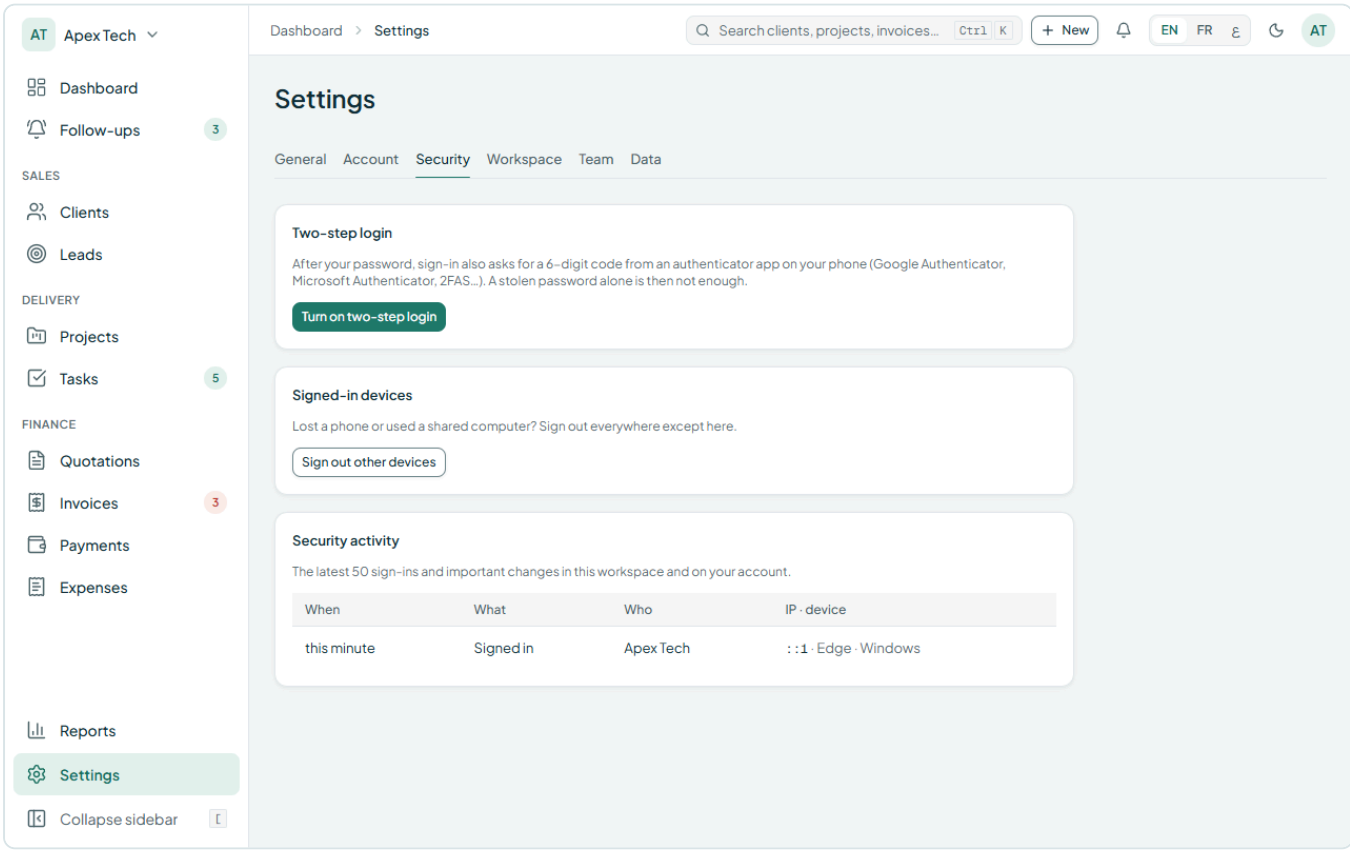
For your safety the page always says “If an account exists for this email, we sent a link” — it never tells strangers who has an account. No email? Check the spam folder, wait a few minutes, then use “Send the link again”. You can ask for up to 3 links every 15 minutes; only the newest link works.

Sign out: click your initials in the top-right corner, then “Log out”.

Good to know

After 5 wrong passwords in a row, signing in to that email is paused for 15 minutes. Use “Forgot password?” instead of guessing.

3. Your account and security



Settings › Security: two-step login, signed-in devices and the security log.

Name, email and password (Settings › Account)

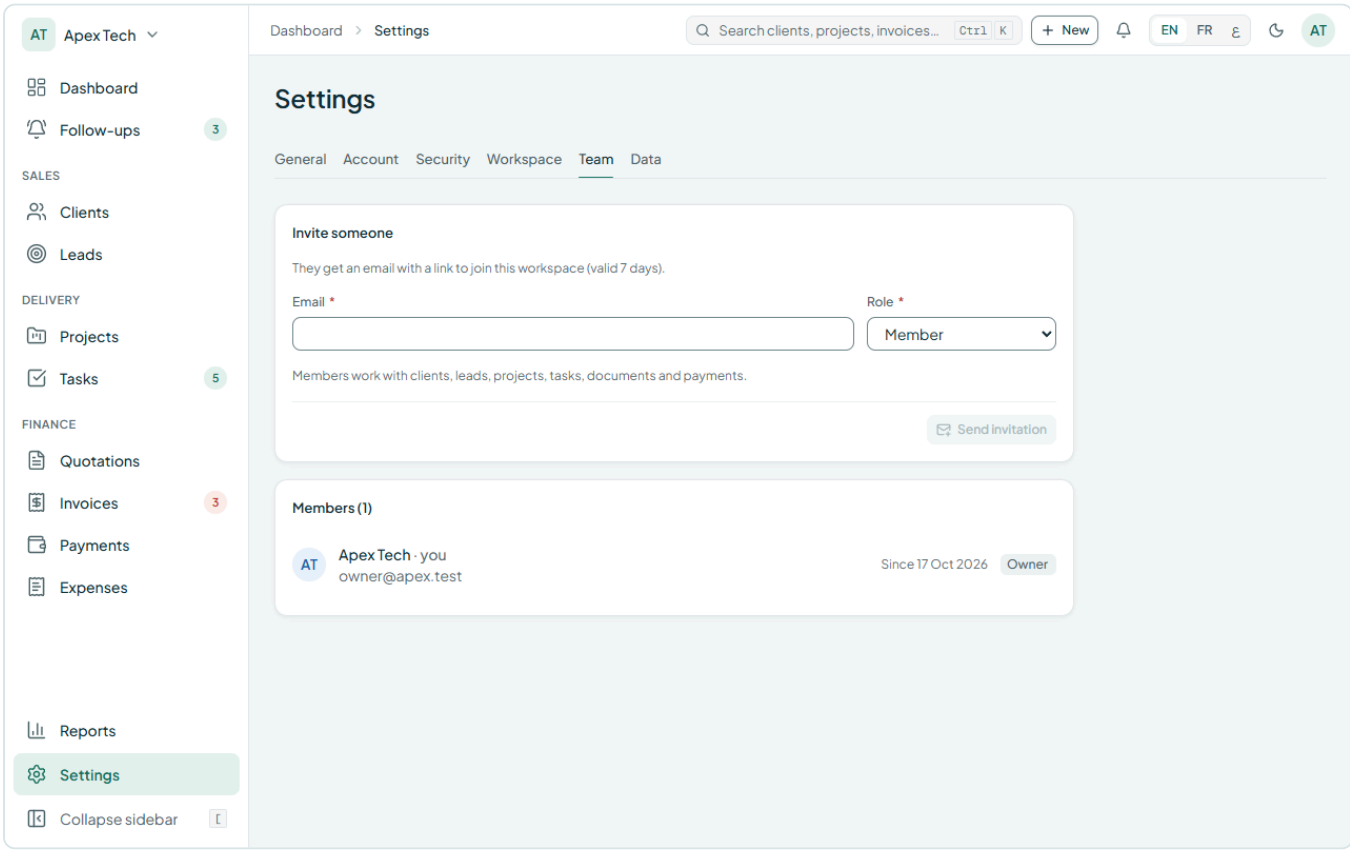
- Change your name at any time.
- Change email: type the new address and your current password. We email a link to the new address; your email changes only when you click it, and the old address is told.
- Change password: type the current one and the new one twice. Every other device is signed out and you receive a notice by email.
- Signed up with Google? Use “Email me a link to set a password” to be able to sign in with your email too.

Two-step login (Settings › Security)

1. Install an authenticator app on your phone (Google Authenticator, Microsoft Authenticator, 2FAS...).
2. Click “Turn on two-step login”, scan the QR code with the app, and type the 6-digit code it shows.
3. Save the ten recovery codes (download them, tick “I saved my recovery codes”). Each works once if you lose your phone.
4. From now on, sign-in asks for the code after your password.

- “Sign out other devices” signs out every other browser and phone (lost phone, shared computer).
- “Security activity” lists the last sign-ins and important changes with the IP address and device.
- Settings › Data › “Download my data” gives you everything stored about you; owners and admins can download the whole workspace.
- Settings › Account › “Delete my account” removes your account for good (download your data first).

4. Working as a team

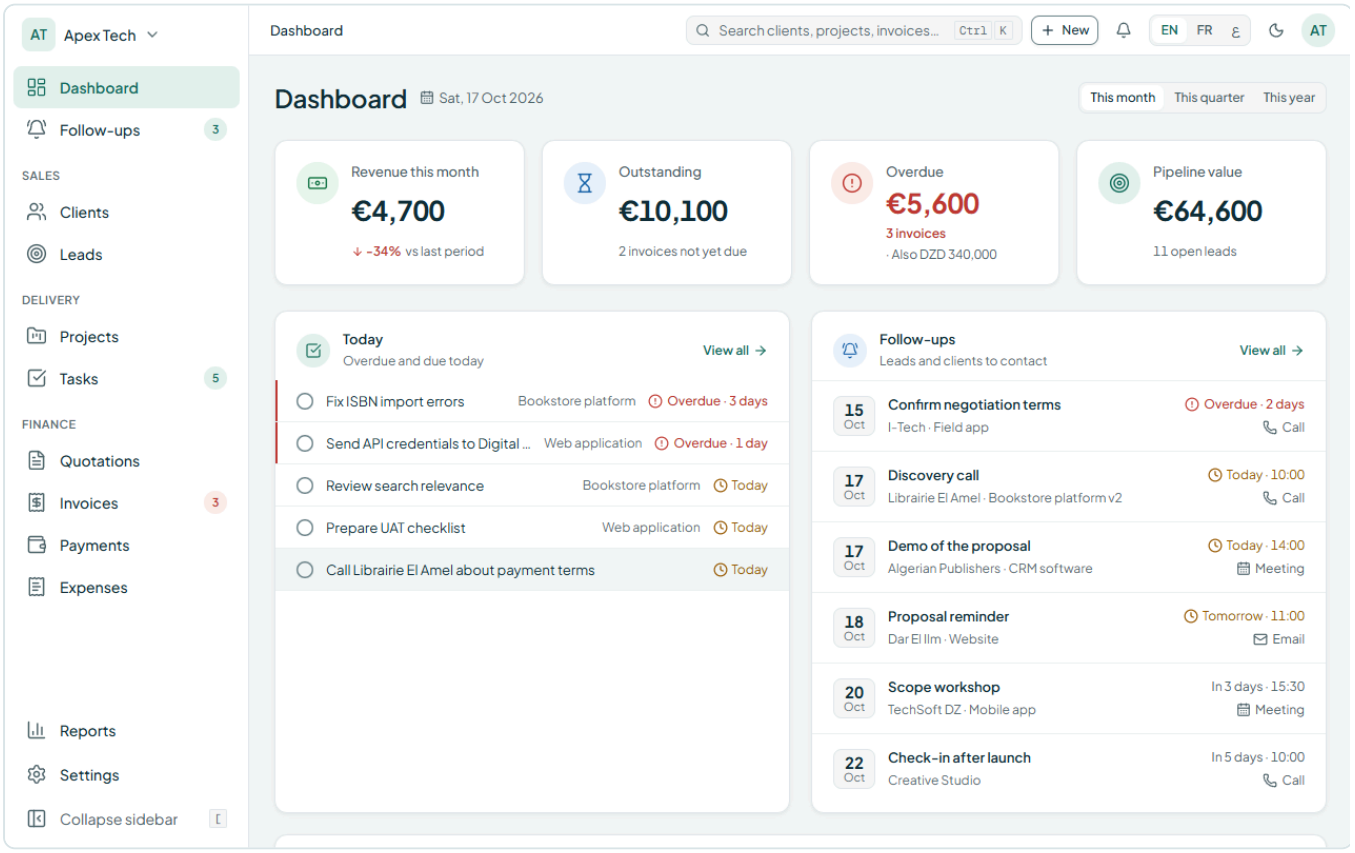


Settings › Team: members, roles and invitations.

1. Settings › Team: type a colleague's email, choose a role, click “Send invitation”.
2. They receive an email and click “Accept the invitation”. If they have no account yet, they choose their name and a password; the link proves their email.
3. They now see the same clients, invoices and tasks as you.

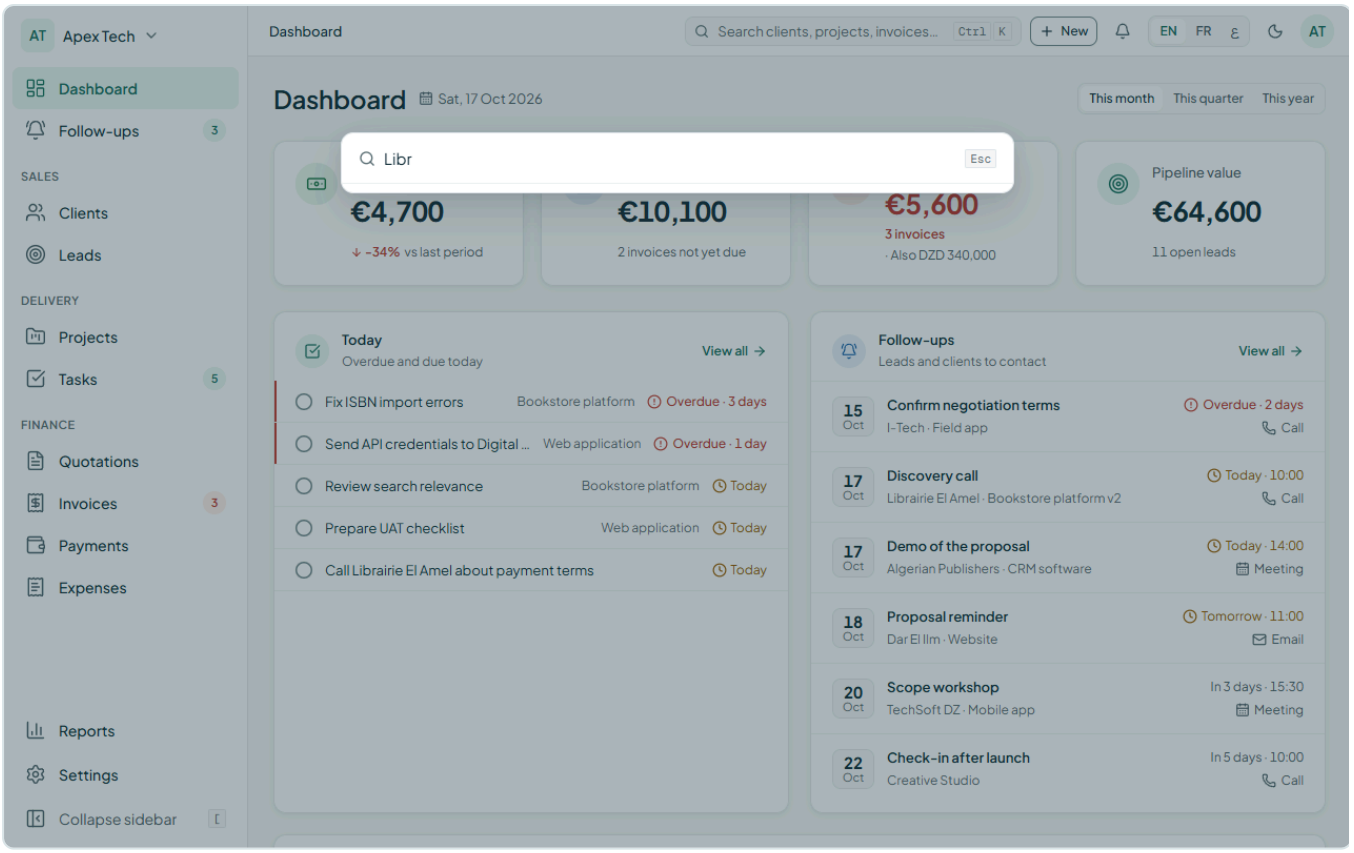
- Owner: everything, including making other owners. A workspace always keeps at least one owner.
- Admin: manages the team, company details, data export, and can void invoices.
- Member: works with clients, leads, projects, tasks, documents and payments.
- Change a role from the list, or remove someone with ×. Invitations can be resent or cancelled.
- Someone in several workspaces switches between them from the workspace name at the top of the sidebar.

5. Finding your way around



The dashboard, with the sidebar on the side and the top bar.

- Sidebar: every module, grouped into Sales, Delivery and Finance. Small numbers show what needs you (tasks due, overdue invoices). Press [to fold it into a thin rail and get more room.
- Search (top bar, or Ctrl+K): type any client, project or invoice number and press Enter to open it.
- "+ New": create a client, lead, project, invoice or task from anywhere.
- Bell: notifications. Moon/Sun: dark or light theme. EN / FR / ع: language.
- Your initials: settings and Log out.
- On a phone, the sidebar hides behind the ☰ button at the top-left (top-right in Arabic).



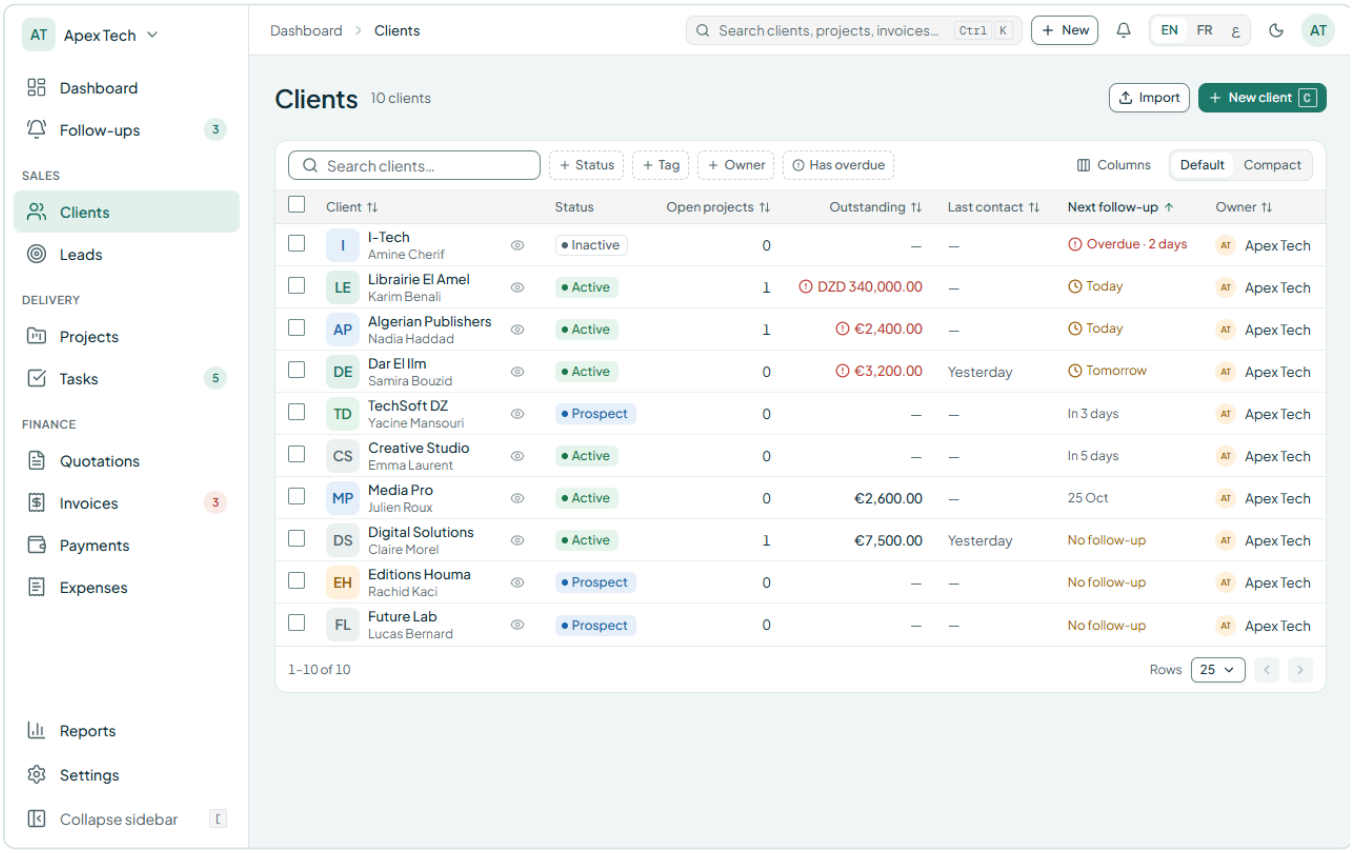
Search with Ctrl+K.

- The bell shows what happened for you: a payment received, a task given to you, a colleague who joined, an invoice gone overdue. Click one to open it; “Mark all read” clears the dot.
- On a phone: open the site, then the browser menu › “Add to Home screen” (or “Install app”). Apex CRM then opens full-screen like an app.

6. Dashboard — your day at a glance

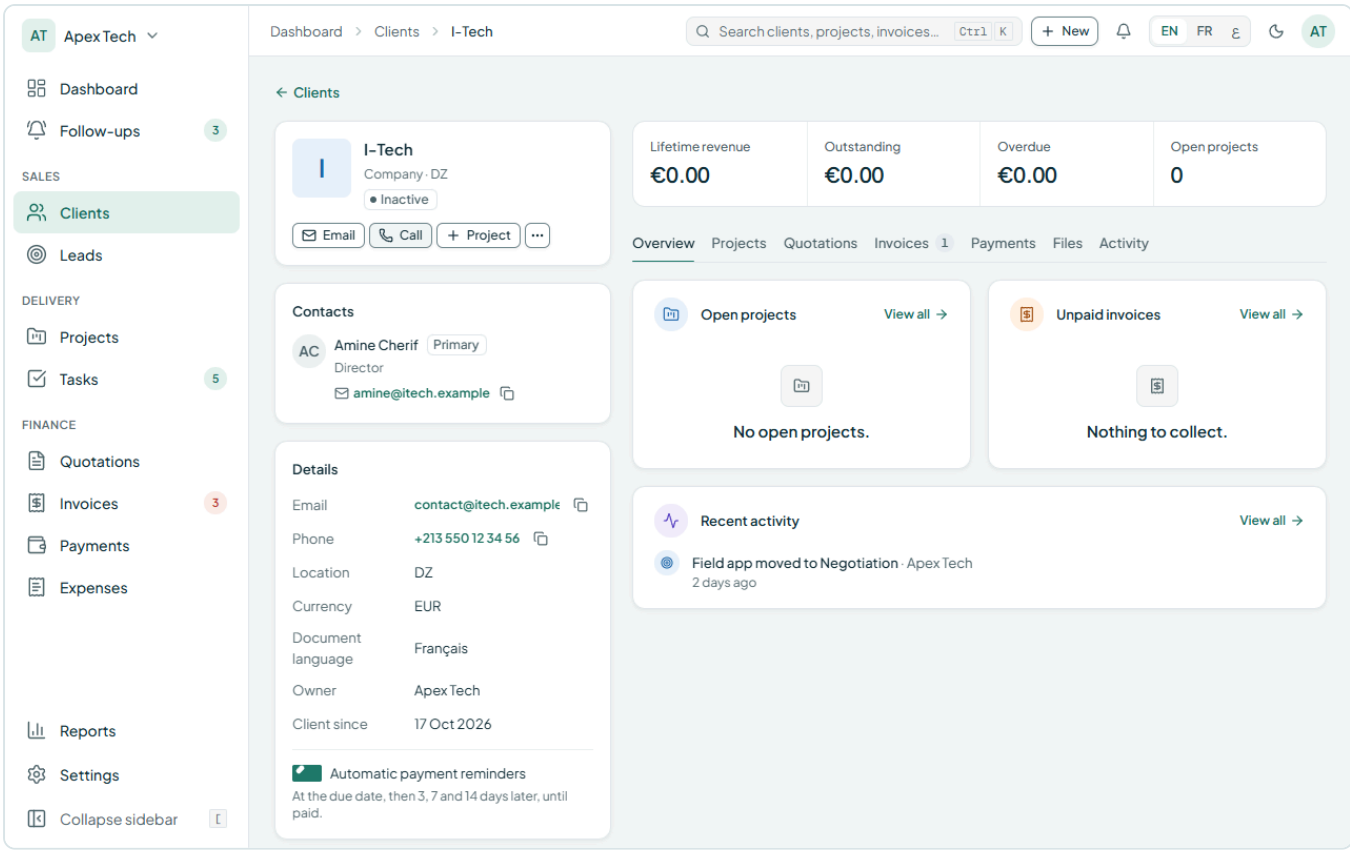
- The four numbers at the top: revenue this month, money outstanding, overdue invoices, and the value of open deals. Click one to see the list behind it. Switch the period with This month / This quarter / This year.
- Today: your tasks due today — tick the box to mark one done (Undo appears for a few seconds).
- Follow-ups: who you promised to call or email.
- Overdue invoices: with a “Send reminder” button for each.
- Charts: invoiced vs collected, and your pipeline by stage. “View as table” shows the same numbers as a table.

7. Clients



The client list.

1. Click “New client” (or press C anywhere). Fill in the name and the details you have, then save.
2. Use the search box and the filter chips (Status, Tag, Owner, Has overdue) to narrow the list. Click a column title to sort.
3. Tick clients to export them to a CSV file or archive them (Undo is offered).
4. Click a client to open its profile.

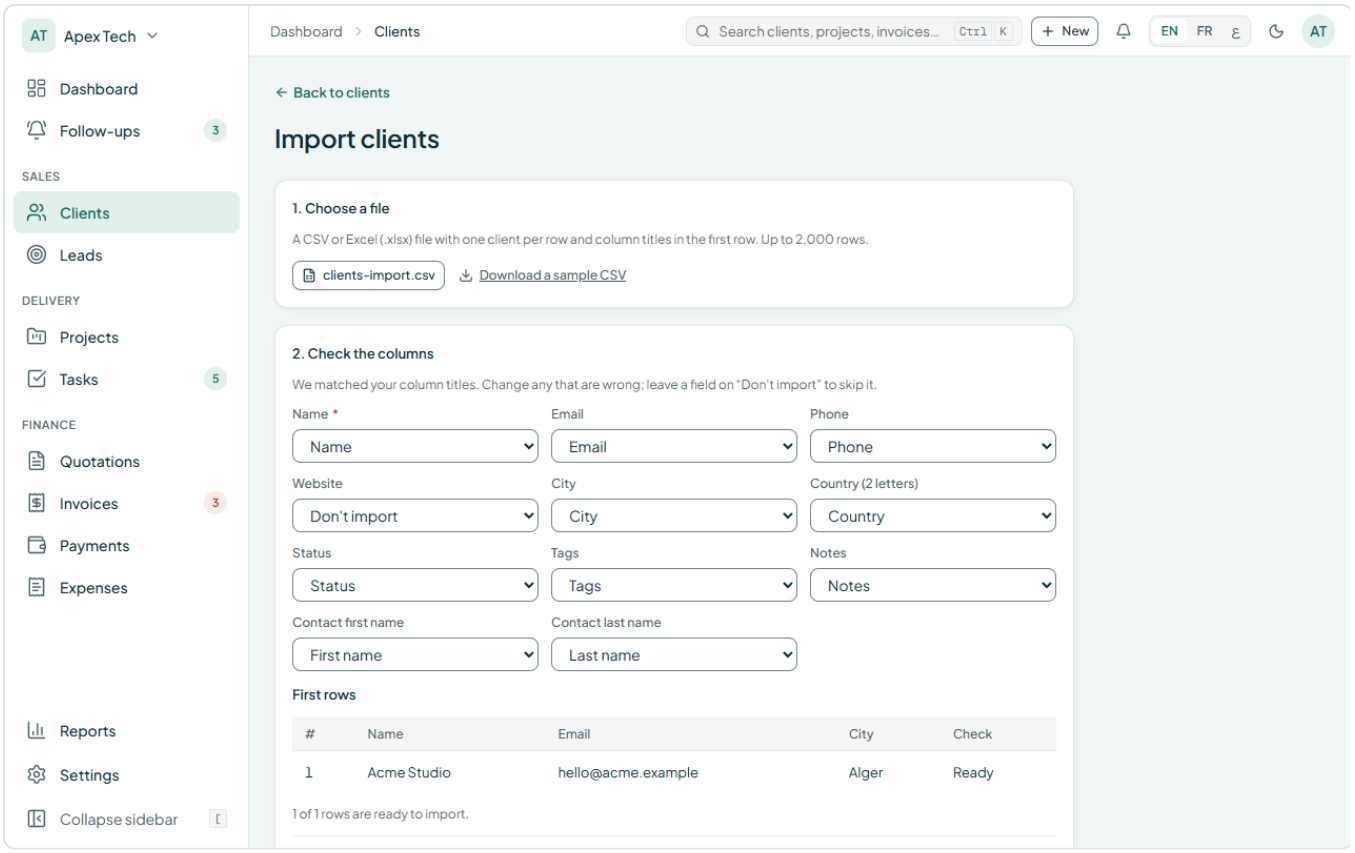


A client profile.

The profile shows contacts and details on the side, key numbers on top (billed, paid, outstanding), and tabs for projects, invoices, quotations and the activity timeline. In Activity you can log a call, an email, a meeting or a note — it stays in the client's history. Plan the next follow-up from the same place.

Quick look, columns, files, import

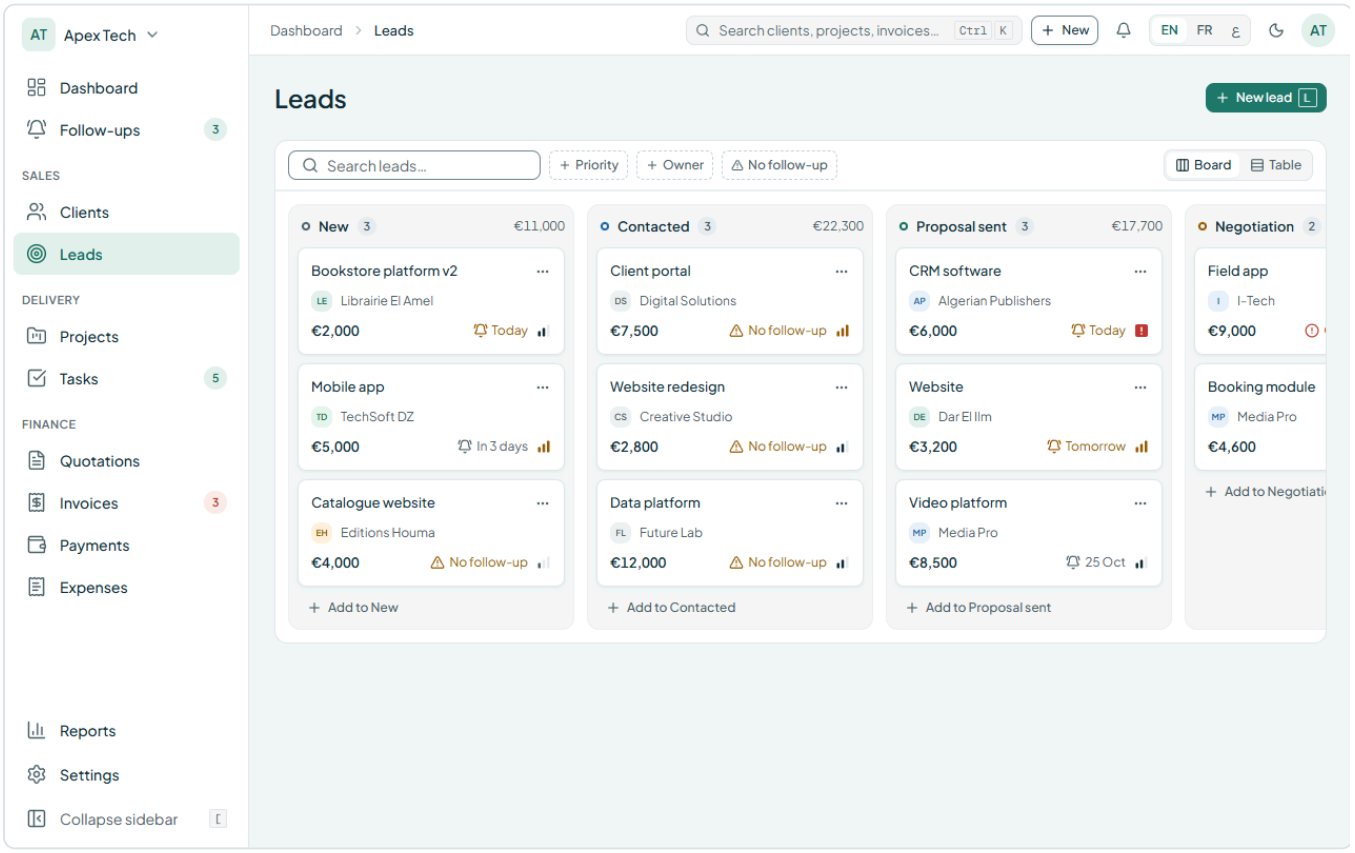
- The eye icon next to a name opens a quick look (contact, amount due, recent activity) without leaving the list. Esc closes it.
- “Columns” chooses which columns the list shows; your choice is remembered.
- A client's Files tab keeps contracts, briefs and photos (up to 4 MB each: PDF, images, Office, text, CSV, ZIP). Only your workspace can download them.



Importing a client list from a spreadsheet.

1. Clients › "Import" › choose a CSV or Excel (.xlsx) file with one client per row and column titles on the first row (a sample file is offered).
2. Check the columns we matched (name, email, phone, city, tags, contact…) and the preview.
3. Click "Import". Rows without a name, with a broken email, or already in your list are skipped and listed.

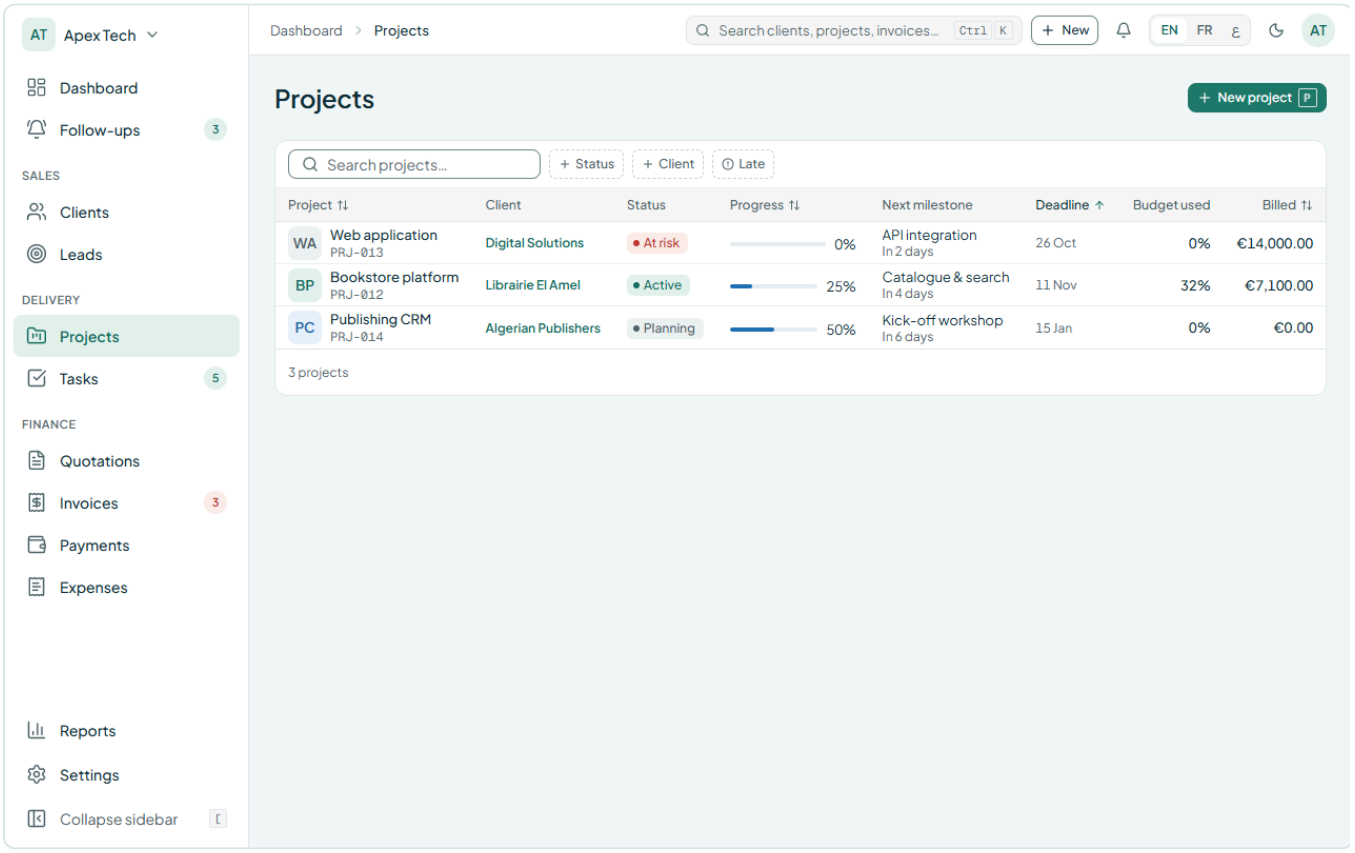
8. Leads — your sales pipeline



The lead board: one column per stage.

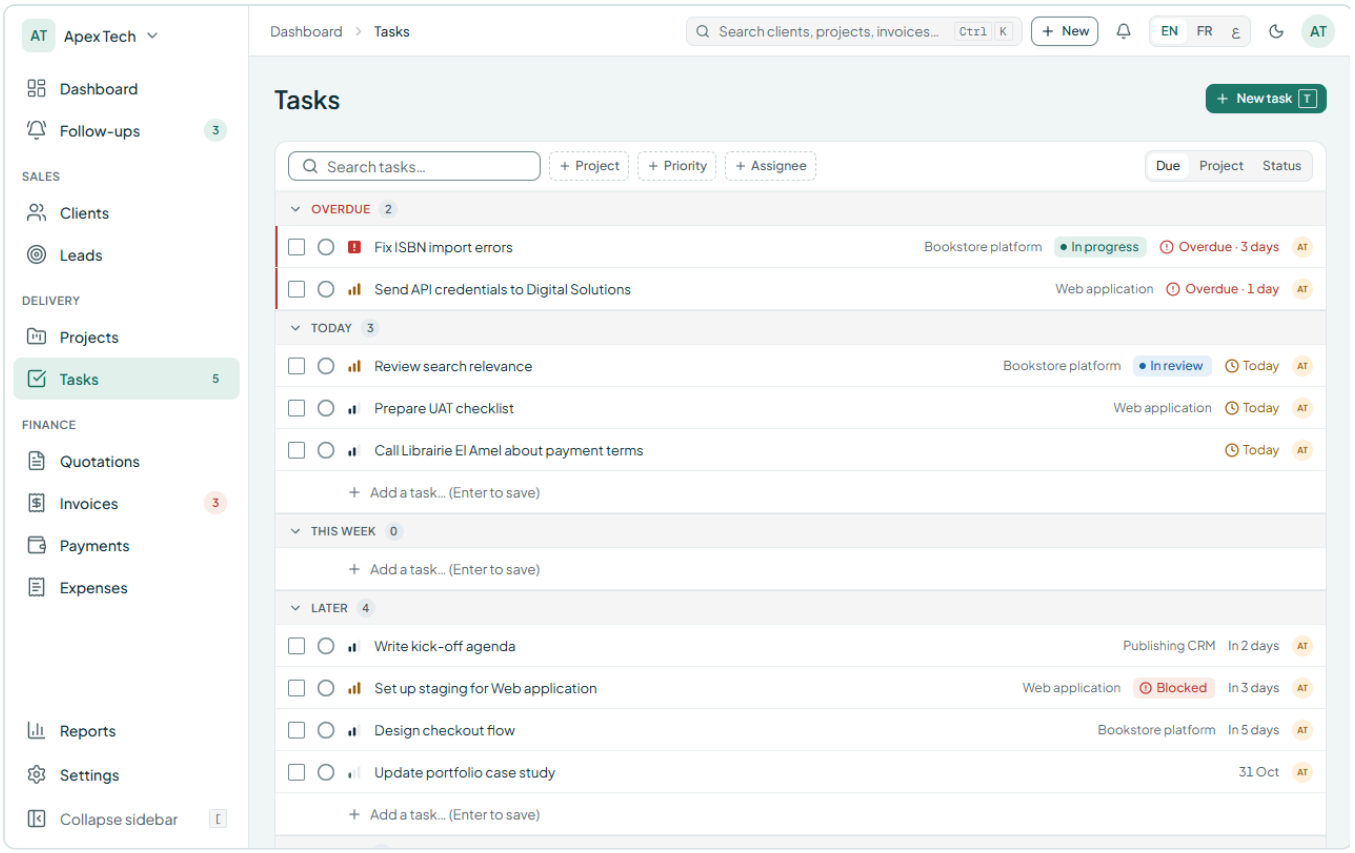
1. Click “New lead” (or press L). Give it a title, the client or prospect, an estimated value and a priority.
2. Move a lead to the next stage by dragging its card to another column. With the keyboard: focus the card and use the “Move to” menu.
3. When you win a deal, mark it as won: type the final value, then choose “Convert to project” or create a quotation straight away.
4. When you lose one, mark it as lost and pick the reason. Reports later show why deals are lost.
5. Prefer a list? Switch the view from Board to Table.

9. Projects and tasks



The project list with progress and budget.

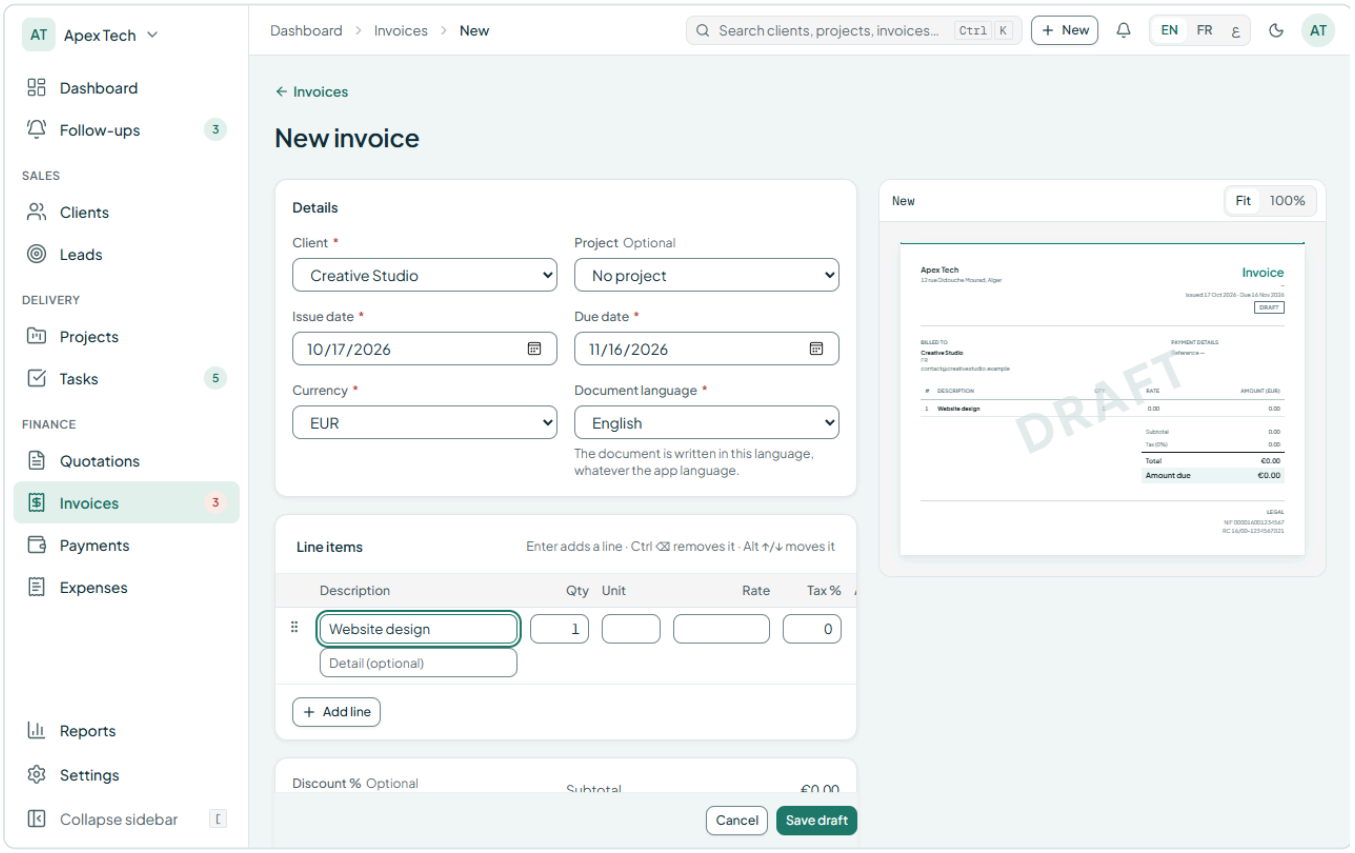
Each project has a code (PRJ-001…), a client, a deadline, a budget and milestones. The list shows progress, the next milestone and how much is billed. Open a project to change its status, add milestones and tasks, and bill milestones with “Create invoice”.



Tasks grouped by due date.

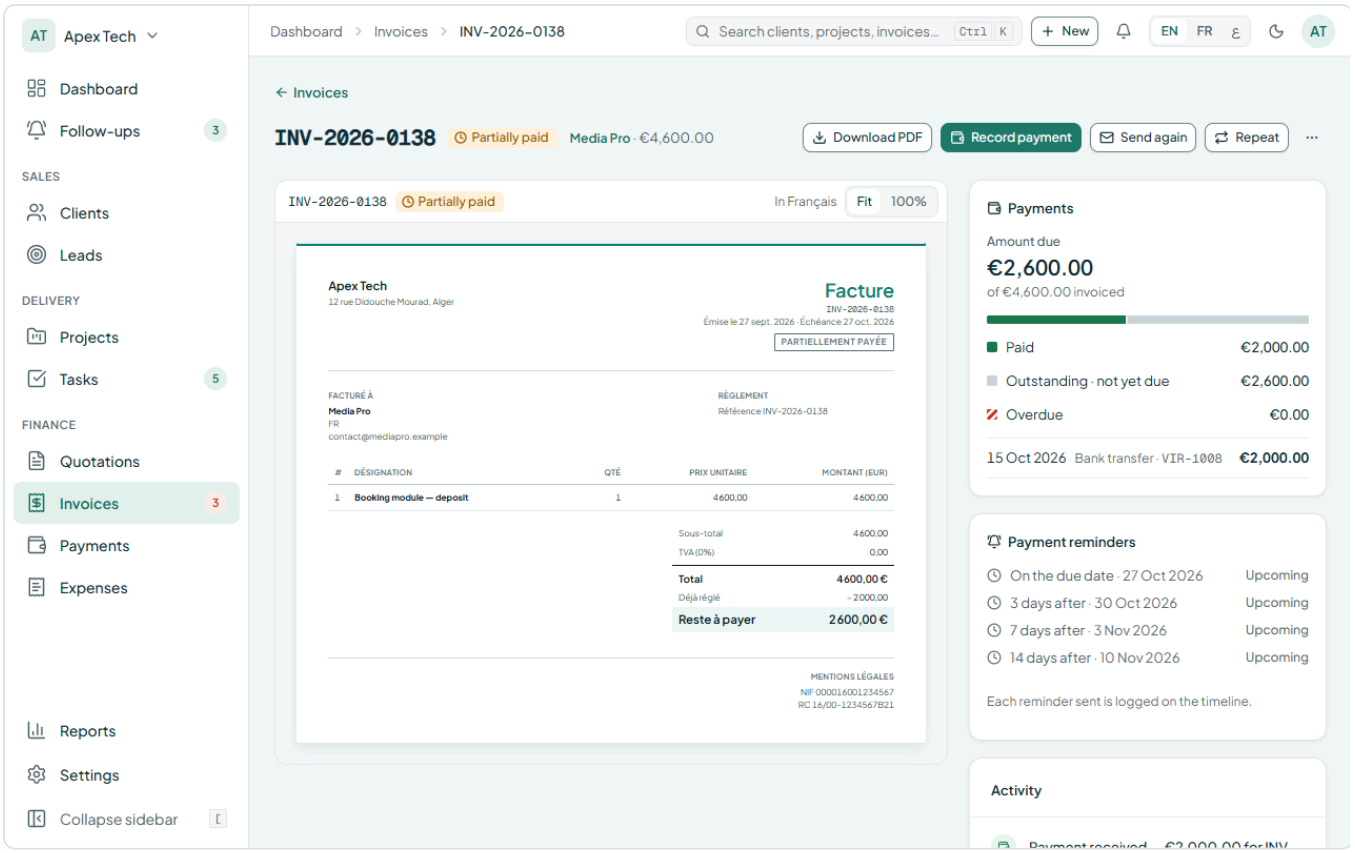
1. Tasks are grouped by due date: Overdue, Today, This week, Later, No date. Change “Group by” to see them by project or status.
2. Tick the circle to complete a task. Type in the “Add a task…” line of any group and press Enter to add one quickly.
3. Select several tasks to move their due date or mark them done together.
4. Click a task to edit it or delete it (Undo is offered).

10. Quotations and invoices



The invoice editor: lines on the left, live preview on the right.

1. Click “New invoice” (or press I), or “New quotation” in Quotations.
2. Choose the client. Add lines: description, quantity, unit price, discount and tax. Press Enter to add the next line. Totals update as you type.
3. The preview shows the real document, in the client's document language (French, English or Arabic).
4. Save the draft, then click “Send”: check the email and click Send. The client receives it with the PDF attached, from your company name; replies come to you.
5. “Download PDF” downloads the same PDF file.



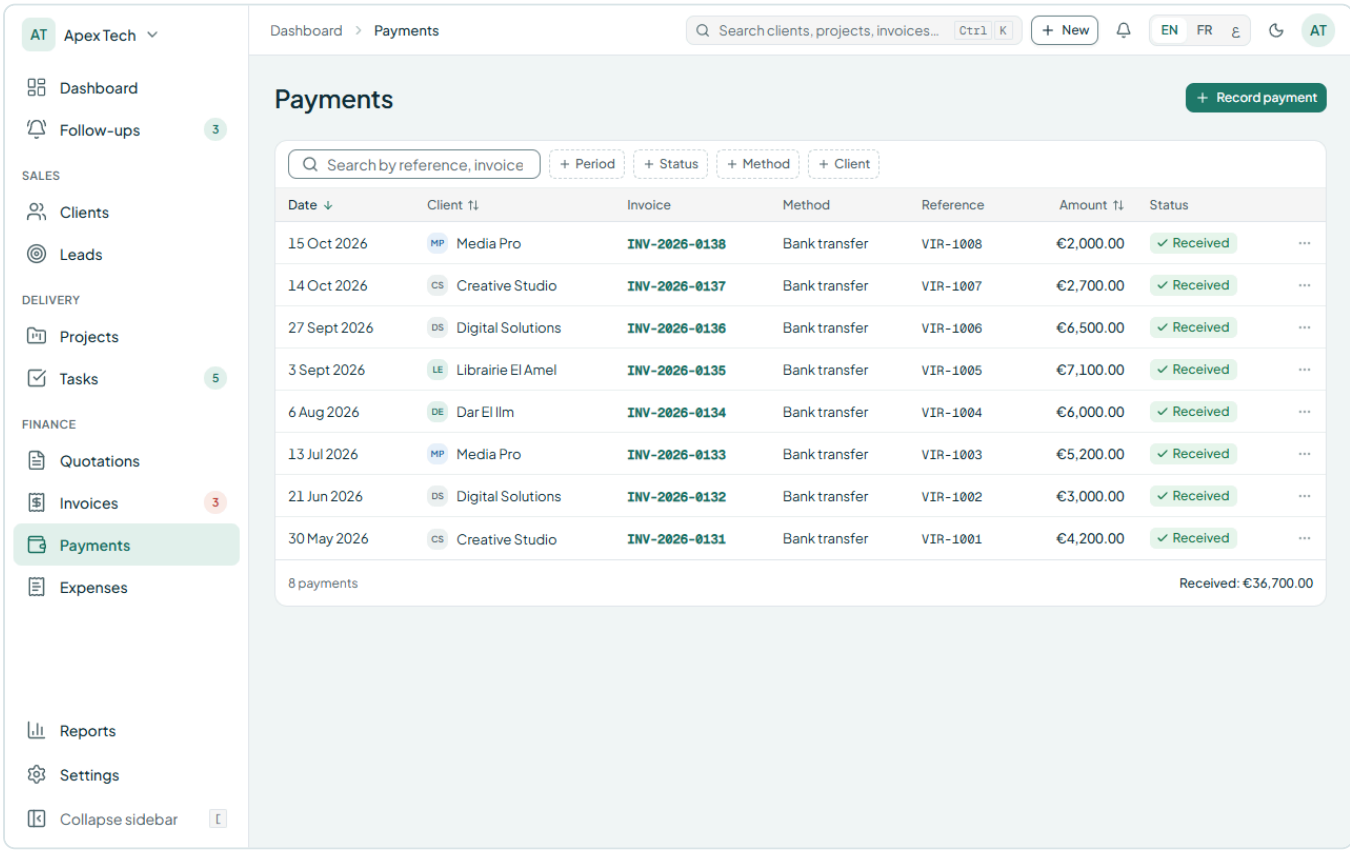
An invoice after it was sent, with its payment summary and reminder schedule.

Recurring invoices

1. Open an invoice you bill regularly and click “Repeat”.
2. Choose every month, 3 months or year, the date of the first new invoice, and (optionally) when to stop.
3. Tick “Email it to the client automatically” to send each new invoice, or leave it unticked to get a draft to check.
4. Invoices › “Recurring invoices” lists every schedule, with Pause, Resume and Delete.

- Numbers are automatic: INV-2026-0001 for invoices, Q-2026-001 for quotations.
- A quotation can be marked Accepted or Declined, and converted to an invoice in one click.
- An invoice becomes Overdue by itself after its due date. “Send reminder” emails the client a reminder with the PDF.
- Void an invoice (owners and admins) instead of deleting it; the number stays used, so your numbering has no gaps.

11. Payments and reminders

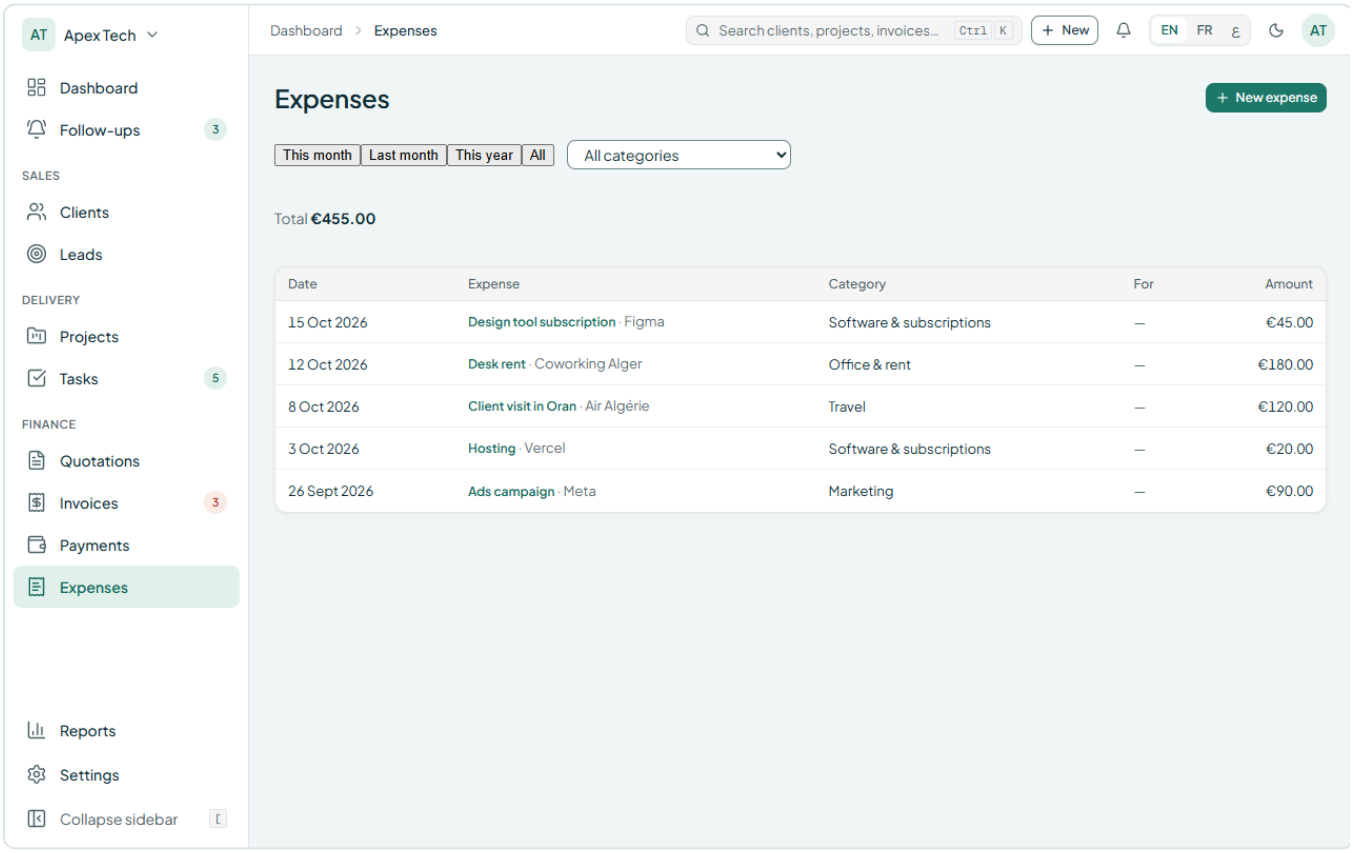


All payments, with filters.

1. Open an invoice and click “Record payment”, or use “Record payment” in Payments.
2. Type the amount, the date and the method (transfer, cash, cheque, card…). A partial amount leaves the rest outstanding; the invoice shows “Partially paid”.
3. When everything is paid the invoice turns “Paid” by itself.

Reminders go out by themselves: every morning, unpaid invoices get a polite email with the PDF on the due date, then 3, 7 and 14 days later. Each invoice shows its schedule (sent, due, skipped, upcoming). Switch reminders off for a client who prefers a phone call (client profile › Automatic payment reminders).

12. Expenses and profit

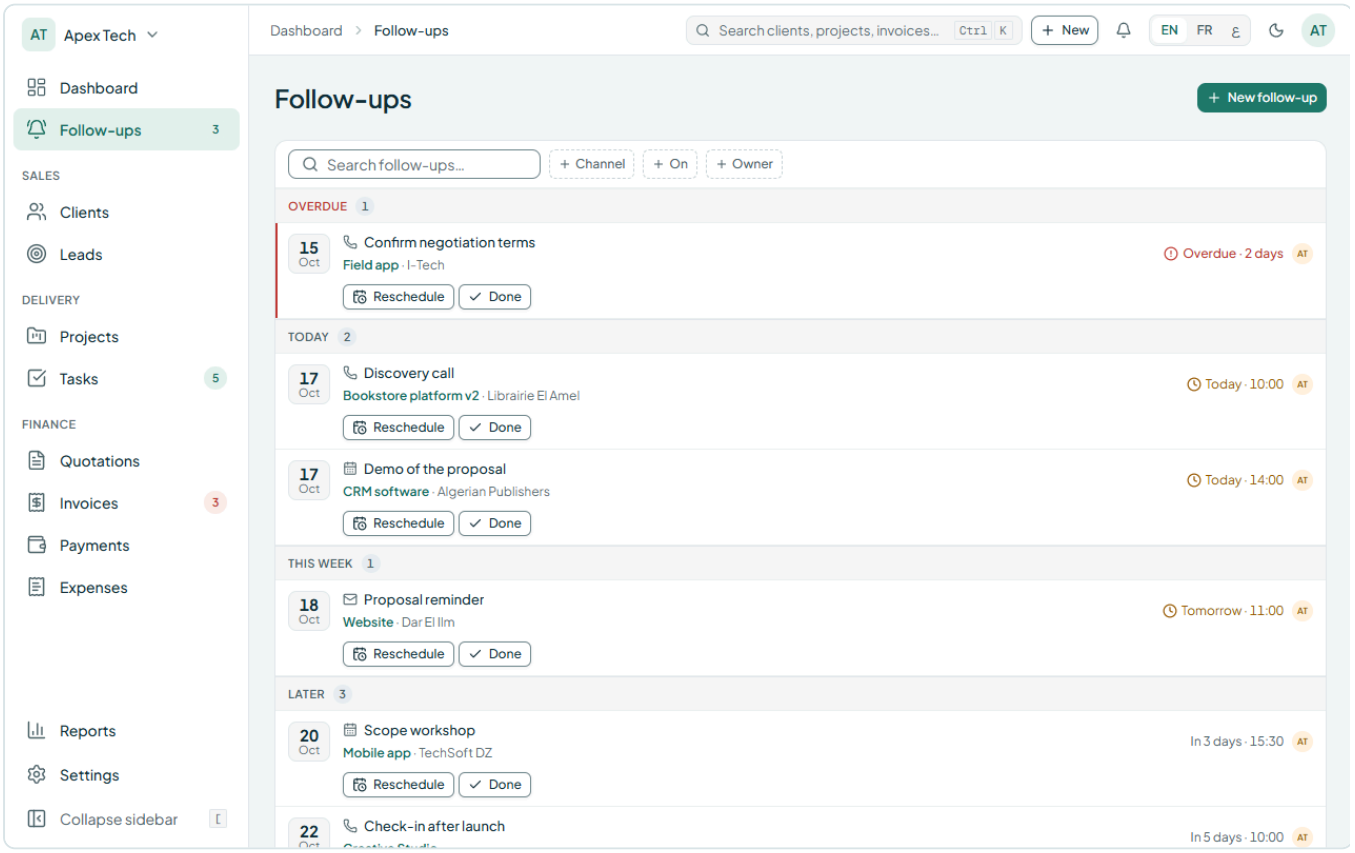


Expenses by period and category.

1. Finance › Expenses › "New expense": what it was for, amount, date, category, and who you paid.
2. Link it to a client or project to see what each one really costs.
3. Filter by month, last month, year or category; the total is shown above the list.

Reports › "Expenses & profit" shows what you collected, what you spent, and the profit for the period.

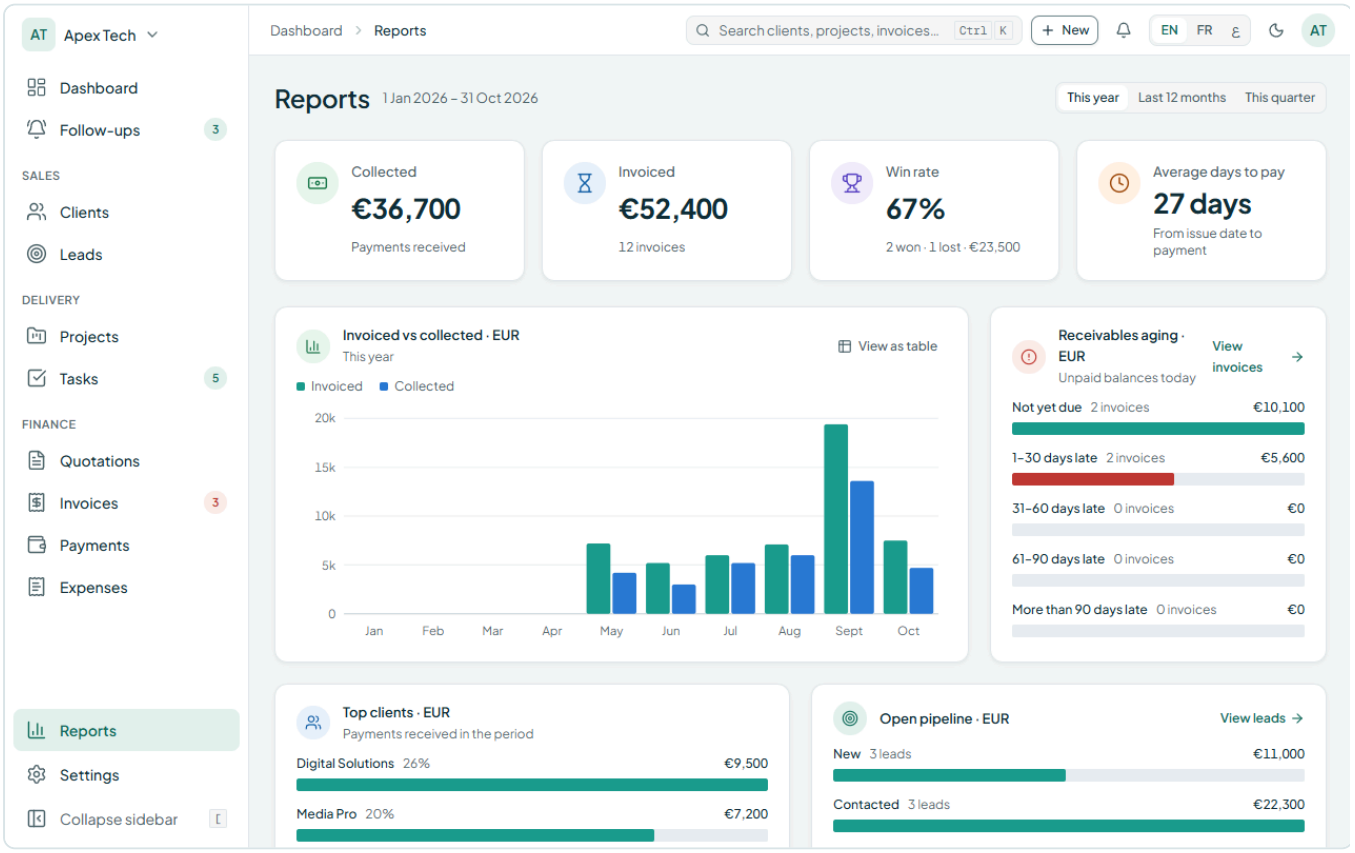
13. Follow-ups



Follow-ups grouped by due date.

A follow-up is a promise: “call Karim on Thursday”. Create one with “New follow-up” or from a client or lead. When it is done, record the outcome and plan the next one in the same step. Late follow-ups stay at the top until you deal with them.

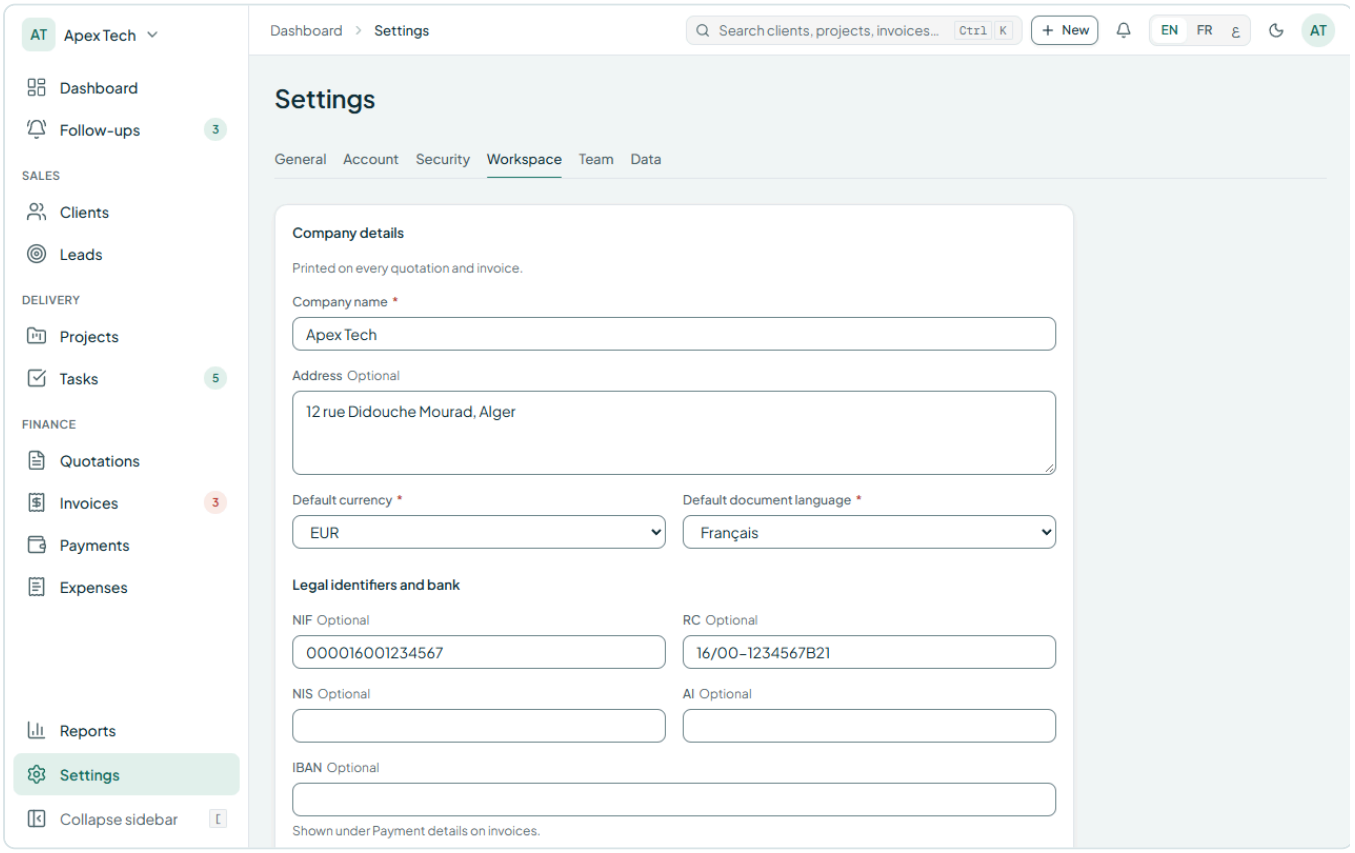
14. Reports



Reports.

- Collected, invoiced, win rate and average days to get paid, for the period you choose.
- Month by month chart of invoiced vs collected.
- Receivables aging: how much is 1–30, 31–60, 61–90 or 90+ days late. Click a bar to open those invoices.
- Top clients, open pipeline by stage, and the reasons deals were lost.
- Expenses & profit: collected minus expenses, with your spending by category.

15. Settings



Settings › Workspace: details printed on your documents.

- General: language, theme (light, dark, or follow the computer) and sidebar.
- Account: name, email, password, delete account.
- Security: two-step login, sign out other devices, security activity.
- Workspace (owners and admins): company name, address, NIF, RC, NIS, AI, IBAN, currency and document language — printed on every quotation and invoice.
- Team: members, roles and invitations. Data: download your data or the whole workspace.

Shortcut	What it does
`Ctrl + K · /`	Search and jump anywhere
`G → D / C / L / P / T / I`	Press G, then the letter: Dashboard / Clients / Leads / Projects / Tasks / Invoices
`C · L · P · I · T`	New client, lead, project, invoice, task
`[`	Fold or unfold the sidebar
`Esc`	Close a window or menu

16. For the owner: putting Apex CRM online

The file DEPLOY.md in the project explains every step in detail. In short:

1. Push the code to your private GitHub repository.
2. Create a new, empty Neon project “apex-crm-production” — separate from the database you use for testing.
3. Import the repository in Vercel, add the settings (DATABASE_URL of the production database, AUTH_SECRET, ENCRYPTION_KEY, CRON_SECRET, APP_URL, email, OPERATOR_NAME, CONTACT_EMAIL) and a private Blob store for files.
4. Deploy. Tables are created automatically; the daily job (reminders, recurring invoices) runs every morning.
5. Open /signup to create your owner account, fill in Settings › Workspace, turn on two-step login, invite your team.

Email (needed for password reset, invitations and sending invoices)

1. Simplest: a Gmail account. Turn on 2-Step Verification in your Google Account, then create an “App password” named Apex CRM (16 letters).
2. Set SMTP_HOST=smtp.gmail.com, SMTP_PORT=465, SMTP_USER=your Gmail address, SMTP_PASS=the 16 letters, MAIL_FROM="Your Company <your Gmail address>".
3. To send from your own domain or more than ~500 emails a day, use Brevo or Resend and paste their SMTP settings instead.

Good to know

On your own computer, while SMTP_HOST is empty, no real email leaves: every email appears at http://localhost:3000/api/dev/mail.

Tip

Keep the settings private: they hold your database password and secret keys. They are never sent to GitHub.